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## Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

# High in the meltdown

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In today's economic turmoil, everyone's looking at ways to cut down on costs — small businesses are no exception. In fact, small businesses are probably hit the hardest as most of them operate on limited rolling capital and don't have deep pockets to sustain themselves in these times. And they say, *desperate times call for desperate measures*. What can your business do to save costs? Here, we look at some cost-cutting measures that you can deploy.

### Cut your electricity bills

Utility costs can be a killer. For example, setting the air conditioner to 26 degrees will help a long way — the temperature remains pleasant enough to work while drastically reducing your electricity bill. During summers, reduce air-conditioning costs by scheduling your work around the hottest hours of the day, if you work from a home-office. Use fans and ventilators

**There's a lot you can do to reduce your operating costs in these days of economic turmoil — from optimally using your air conditioners to using your printers efficiently**

that open to let out the heat. Have your meter checked if you're getting outlandish bills. It's a matter of filling out and submitting a simple form at your electricity company's office.

Here are things you can do on the IT front:

1. Switching to LCD monitors is a good idea. Some quick back-of-the-envelope calculations show that on an average you should recover the additional investment of LCD over CRT in just three years by way of accrued savings on electricity. Not to mention the space saving, and hey — they look better. Incidentally, LCDs produce less heat, so a marginal decrease in air conditioning costs cannot be ruled out.

2. Switch off the mains to your PCs before leaving. Know that your equipment draws power even when they're off. So when you see the small green light on any device, it's drawing at least a few watts. A recent UN-sponsored study found that up to 10 per cent of your electricity



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